



MindShift

PSYCHOLOGICAL SERVICES



A MINDSHIFT PSYCHOLOGICAL SERVICES GUIDE

The Grounding & Mindfulness Exercise Workbook

*Five guided practices to bring you back to the present moment,
anywhere, anytime.*

Southern California • Individual, Couples & Family Psychotherapy
www.mindshiftwellnesscenter.com • (714) 584-9700





WELCOME

Presence Is a Practice, Not a Personality Trait

Grounding and mindfulness aren't about clearing your mind, they're about noticing where you are without judgment, which is often enough to interrupt spiraling thoughts or overwhelm. These practices are drawn from CBT, DBT, and trauma-informed care.

PRACTICE WHEN CALM

Like any skill, grounding works best under pressure when you've already rehearsed it in calmer moments.

NOTES & REFLECTION

What does it feel like in your body when you're truly present versus caught in your head?

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A full script you can read slowly to yourself or a loved one.

- Look around and silently name 5 things you can see.
- Notice 4 things you can physically feel (your feet on the floor, air on your skin).
- Listen for 3 sounds, near and far.
- Identify 2 things you can smell, or two scents you enjoy.
- Notice 1 thing you can taste, or one thing you're grateful for right now.

NOTES & REFLECTION

Try the scan now. What did you notice? List a few things you saw, heard, or felt.

Breath and Body

Inhale 4 counts. Hold 4. Exhale 4. Hold 4. Repeat 6-8 rounds, tracing a square with your finger if it helps.

Starting at your feet, slowly move your attention upward through your body. At each area, just notice: tight or loose, warm or cool, heavy or light. No need to change anything, just observe.

After trying box breathing or the body scan, what shifted, even slightly, in your body?



Anchors and Compassion

Keep one small object in your pocket or bag, a smooth stone, a piece of fabric. When overwhelmed, hold it and describe its texture, weight, and temperature in detail.

Silently offer yourself these phrases, adapted from self-compassion research: “May I be safe. May I be at ease. May I be gentle with myself.” Repeat for 3-5 rounds.

What object could become your self-soothe anchor? What phrase do you want to remember?

PRACTICE TRACKER

My Weekly Grounding Log

Jot a quick note after each practice, patterns will show you what works best for you.

Monday — practice used & how I felt after:

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Tuesday — practice used & how I felt after:

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Wednesday — practice used & how I felt after:

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Thursday — practice used & how I felt after:

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Friday — practice used & how I felt after:

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Weekend — practice used & how I felt after:

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BEFORE YOU GO

You Don't Have to Carry This Alone

Reaching for a resource like this one is already an act of self-care. If anything here resonated, know that our licensed California clinicians are ready to help you go deeper — with real support, tailored to your story, at a pace that feels right for you.

Rachael Morua, LMFT, CST

License #LMFT106917 • Founder, MindShift Psychological Services
On behalf of the licensed clinicians of the MindShift care team

MINDSHIFT PSYCHOLOGICAL SERVICES

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IF YOU ARE IN CRISIS

Call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911. You deserve support right now.



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Contact Us to Get Started

